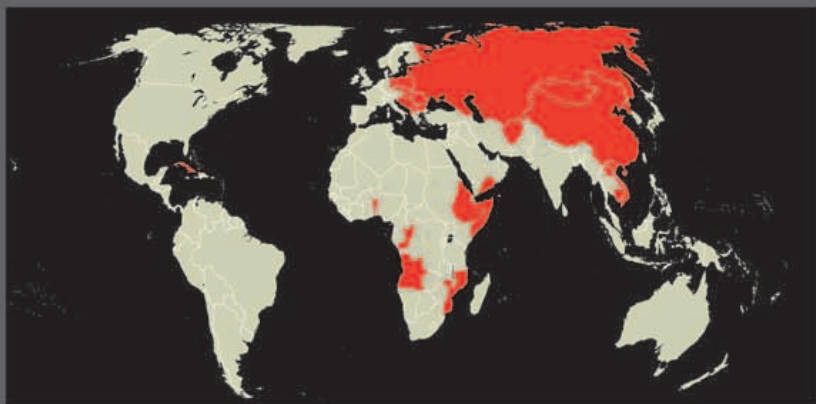




BEFORE Communist regimes could be found across the world at the high point of communist influence. After Soviet triumph in World War II, communism was embraced by one-third of the world's population. Fear that it would spread further dominated the conduct of the Cold War.



AFTER Today, there are only five communist countries in the world. China remains one of the most prominent, while Laos, Vietnam, North Korea, and Cuba also have communist regimes. Communist parties still exist in many democratic nations.